

1 Path analysis

Path	B	SE	z	p	Std. β	95% CI	R ²
esg_score $\rightarrow$ norm_score	-0.10	0.05	-1.93	.054	-.10	[-.20, .00]	.01
norm_score $\rightarrow$ intent_score	0.25	0.05	5.30	<.001	.26	[.17, .35]	.17
esg_score $\rightarrow$ intent_score	0.35	0.04	7.82	<.001	.34	[.26, .42]	.17

Path	Estimate	SE	boot 95% CI	p
esg_score $\rightarrow$ norm_score $\rightarrow$ intent_score	-0.03	0.01	[-0.06, -0.00]	.077

esg_score

$\beta = -.10$

Path analysis estimates a system of regressions among observed variables at once, letting one variable be both an outcome and a predictor (mediation). Structural paths: each B is the unstandardized effect, $\text{Std. } \beta$ the standardized effect, with z , p , and a 95% CI; R^2 is the variance explained in each endogenous variable. Indirect effects: the product of the paths through a mediator (e.g. $X \rightarrow M \rightarrow Y$), judged by its bootstrap 95% CI - an interval excluding 0 indicates mediation. When $df = 0$ the model is saturated (it reproduces the data exactly), so fit indices are not informative and are omitted; only with extra constraints ($df > 0$) do global fit indices apply, and even then read RMSEA cautiously at small df / small N . All thresholds are heuristics, not pass/fail gates.

A path model fit to the observed variables; the indirect effect of X on Y through M was significant, bootstrap 95% CI excluding 0. Estimated with maximum likelihood.

Statistical basis: Path model estimation (lavaan::sem, observed variables only) (Rosseel, Y. (2012). "lavaan: An R Package for Structural Equation Modeling." *Journal of Statistical Software*, 48(2), 1-36.); RMSEA interpreted cautiously at small df / small N for over-identified models (Kenny, D. A., Kaniskan, B., McCoach, D. B. (2015). "The performance of RMSEA in models with small degrees of freedom." *Sociological Methods & Research*, 44(3), 486-507.); Bootstrap percentile CIs for indirect (mediated) effects (MacKinnon, D. P., Lockwood, C. M., Williams, J. (2004). "Confidence limits for the indirect effect: Distribution of the product and resampling methods." *Multivariate Behavioral Research*, 39(1), 99-128.).